

FEMA National Watch Center

Daily Operations Briefing

Saturday, September 26, 2026

8:30 a.m. ET



FEMA

National Current Operations / Monitoring

New Significant Incidents / Ongoing Operations:

- Hurricane Nolo (CAT-2) – Hawaii
- Nor'easter – Mid-Atlantic to Northeast

Disaster Declaration Activity:

- Approval: Emergency Declaration – HI
- Amendment No. 2 to FEMA-4935-DR-TX

Hazard Monitoring:

- Heavy Rain / Flash Flooding – Southern Plains, Mid-Atlantic to Northeast
- Tropical Activity:
 - Atlantic:
 - Tropical Storm Gonzalo
 - Tropical Depression Fay
 - Eastern and Central Pacific:
 - Hurricane Nolo (CAT-2)
 - Hurricane Polo (CAT-5)
 - Hurricane Odalys (CAT-3)
- Disturbance 1: High (90%)
- Disturbance 2: High (70%)

Event Monitoring:

- 81st United Nations General Assembly (UNGA) – NY



FEMA

Hurricane Nolo (CAT-2) – Central Pacific



Situation: Hurricane Nolo is nearly stationary south of the Big Island of Hawaii and expected to strengthen into a major hurricane today before peaking in intensity tomorrow. (HLT Update #23, as of 5:00 a.m. ET, Sep 26) Tropical Storm conditions have begun on the Big Island and hurricane conditions are possible today, particularly in areas of steep terrain, and a Tropical Storm Watch is in effect for Maui County. Life-threatening, catastrophic flooding and mudslides are possible due to periods of heavy rain across the Big Island and Maui through the weekend. (NWS Forecast Station Hawaii, as of 11:00 p.m. ET, Sep 25)

Hazards Affecting Land: (HLT Update #23, as of 5:00 a.m. ET, Sep 26)

Wind: Tropical storm conditions are occurring in portions of the warning area, with hurricane conditions possible today, particularly in areas of steep terrain

Rainfall: For the eastern and southern portions of the Big Island, Nolo will produce rainfall totals of 8-12 inches with maximum amounts of 16 inches; in Maui, rainfall totals of 4-6 inches with maximum amounts of 8 inches are expected; maximum rainfall totals of 1-2 inches are expected across the rest of the Hawaiian islands

Storm Surge: Peak storm surge up to 3 feet is forecast for Hawaii County

Lifeline Impacts: (Hurricane Nolo SLB #2, as of 11:52 p.m. ET, Sep 25)

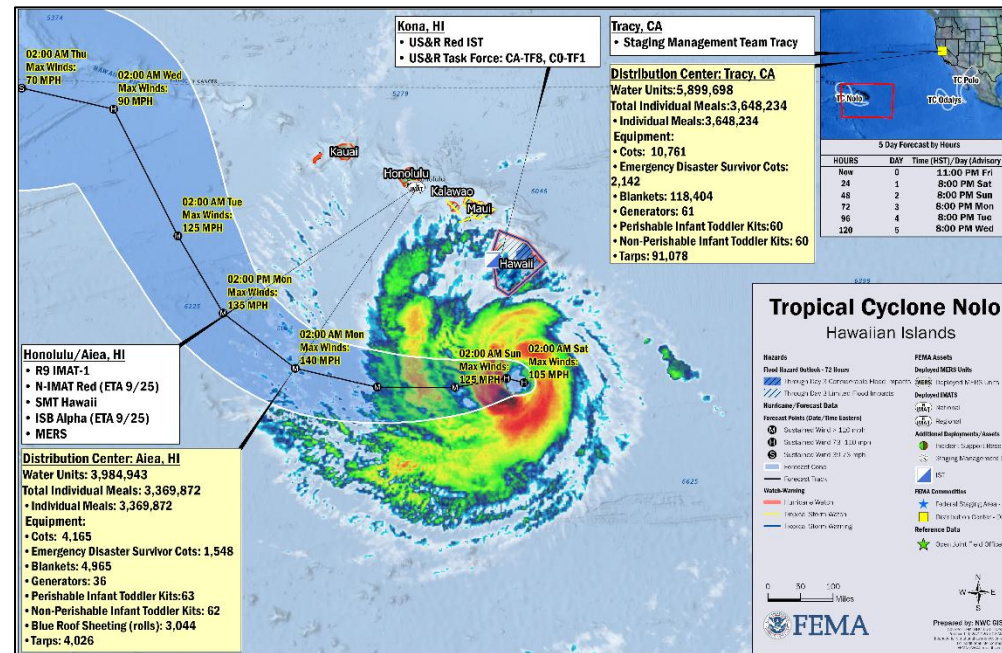
Safety and Security: State USAR resources being staged

- National Guard activated across all counties
- 2 USAR Teams arrived on the Big Island Sep 25
- Hawaii and Maui county schools and government offices remain closed

Food, Hydration, Shelter: Hawaii County: 7 (+4) shelters open / 26 (+17) occupants (ARC, as of 6:50 a.m. ET, Sep 26)

Transportation: Travel restrictions in place in Hawaii and Maui Counties

- Hawaii and Maui County ports at Condition Zulu; Honolulu and Kauai County ports at Condition X-Ray
- Flights to Maui and Hawaii Counties are cancelled as of Sep 25
- Select Hawaii and Maui County roads are closed



NWC will continue to monitor in coordination with FEMA Region 9, with continued reporting twice daily in the FEMA National Situation Report (3:00 a.m./ 5:00 p.m. ET) and the FEMA Daily Operations Briefing (8:30 a.m. ET).

State / Local Response:

- Hawaii SEOC at Full Activation (Tropical Activity)
- Emergency Declaration for Hurricane Nolo approved on Sep 25

FEMA / Federal Response: (R9 SPOTREP Update #7, as of 6:26 a.m. ET, Sep 26)

FEMA Region 9:

- RWC at Enhanced Watch (TC Nolo); RRCC is Activated with select ESFs (12:00 p.m. – 12:00 a.m. ET)
- R-IMAT 1 deployed to HI (DR 4909/4936/EM 3652/TC Nolo); R-IMAT 2 deployed to CNMI (DR-4910/EM-3647)
- FIT LNO deployed to HIEMA, Hawaii and Maui Counties
- Defense Coordinating Element (DCE) Pacific deployed to HI

HQ:

- NWC is Monitoring; will be at Enhanced Watch (TC Nolo/Nor'easter) (12:00 p.m.-12:00 a.m. ET)
- N-IMAT Red deployed to HI
- Logistics: SMT Tracy deployed to DC Tracy, CA; SMT Hawaii and ISB Alpha deployed to DC Hawaii, HI
- DEC: Bothell MERS deployed to Honolulu, HI
- US&R: CA-TF8, C0-TF1, and Red IST deployed to Kona, HI

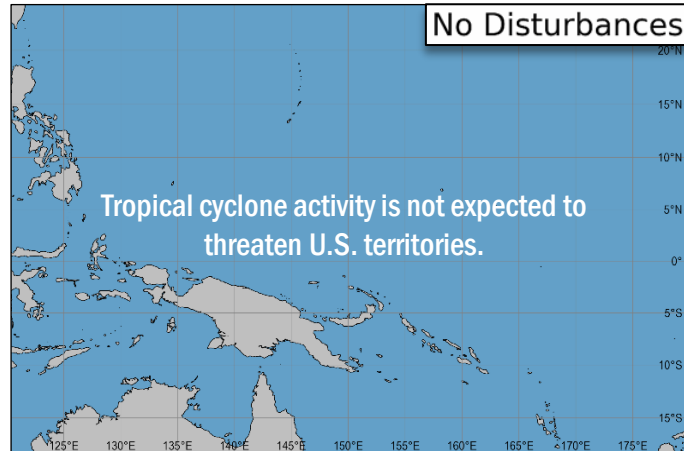


FEMA

National Watch Center

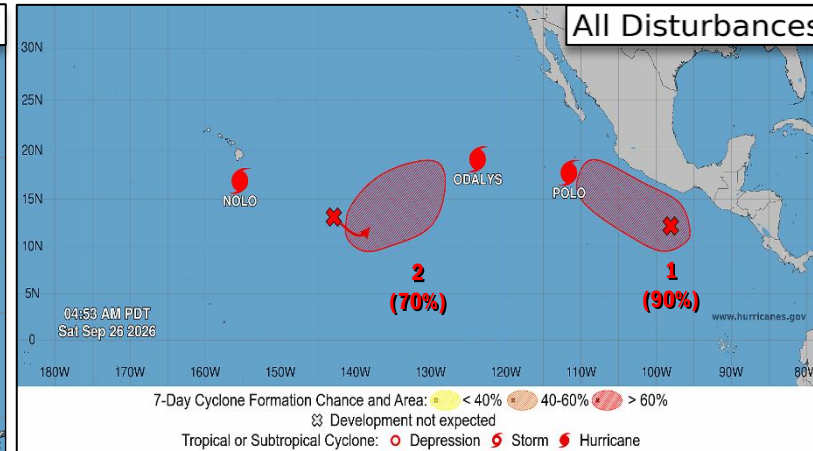
Tropical Outlook

Western Pacific



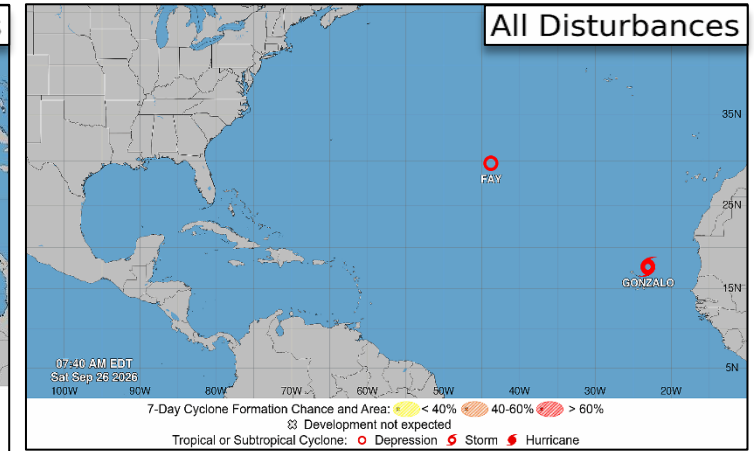
- Tropical cyclone activity is not expected to threaten U.S. territories.

Eastern and Central Pacific



- See next slide
- See next slide
- See next slide
- Located S of the Gulf of Tehuantepec
- Environmental conditions should be favorable for gradual development, and a tropical depression is in the next day or two
- Formation chance – 48-hour: High (90%); 7-day: High (90%)
- Located 1,000 miles ESE of the Hawaiian Islands
- Conditions are favorable for gradual development; a tropical depression could form early to middle of next week
- Formation chance – 48-hour: Low (20%); 7-day: High (70%)

Atlantic



- See next slide
- See next slide



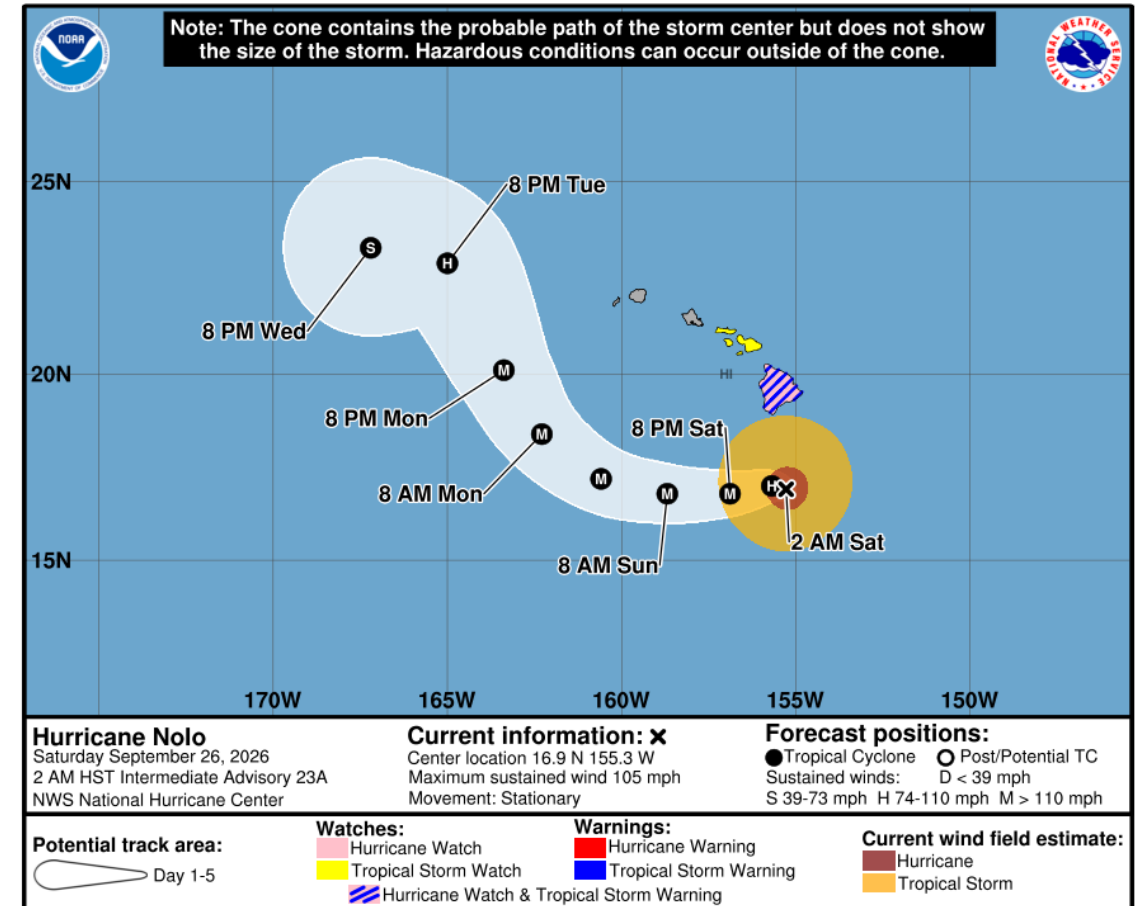
FEMA

National Watch Center

Hurricane Nolo (CAT-2)– Central Pacific

Situation: (Advisory #23A, as of 8:00 a.m. ET)

- Located 145 miles S of South Point Hawaii
- Maximum sustained winds of 105 mph
- Currently stationary
- Hurricane-force winds extend up to 45 miles from center; tropical-storm-force winds extend up to 140 miles from center
- Nolo is expected to become a major hurricane today and peak in intensity by tomorrow with weakening on Monday



FEMA

National Watch Center

Hurricane Polo (CAT-5) – Eastern Pacific

Situation: (Advisory #23A, as of 5:00 a.m. ET)

- Located **425 miles WSW** of **Cabo Corrientes**, Mexico
- Moving **WNW** at 9 mph
- Maximum sustained winds of **160 mph**
- Hurricane-force winds extend up to **35 miles** from center; tropical-storm-force winds extend up to 125 miles from center
- **Slow weakening is expected to begin tonight, but Polo is expected to remain a powerful hurricane as it approached Baja California Sur on Monday**



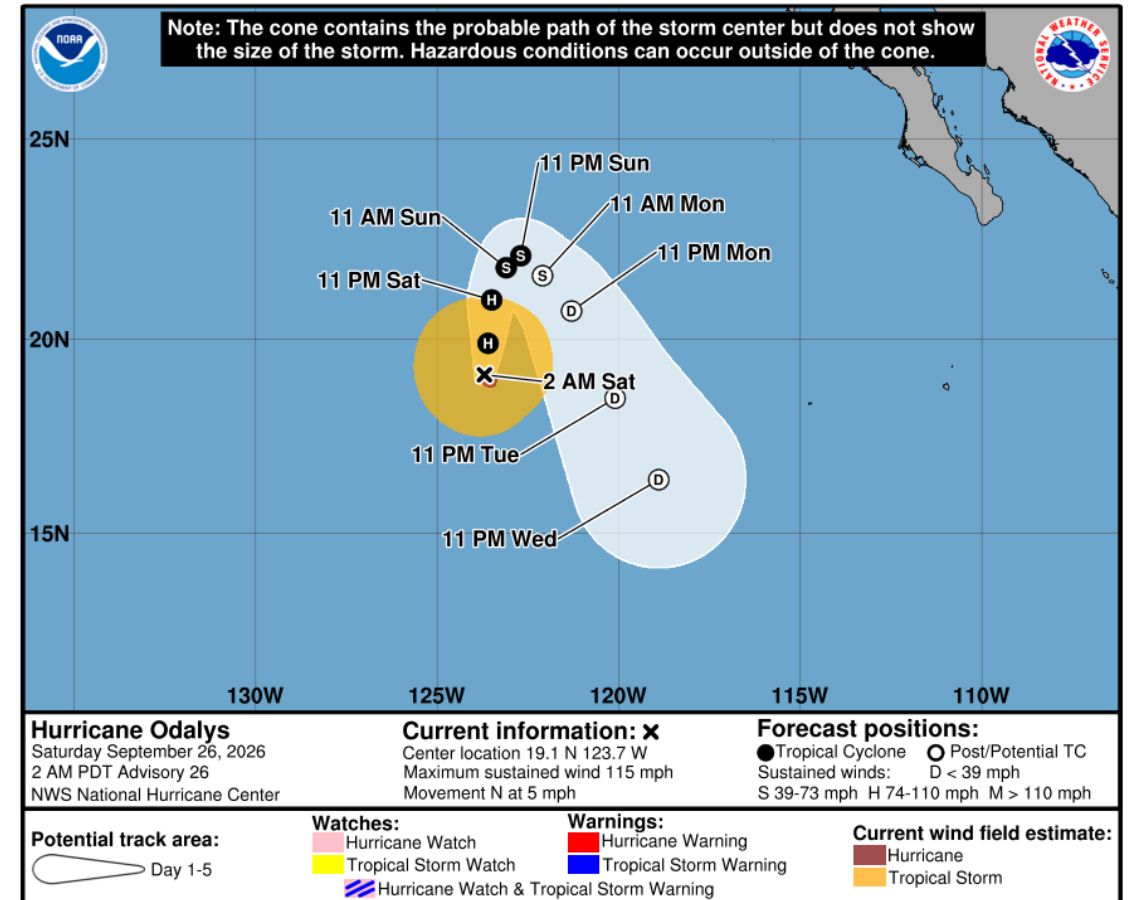
FEMA

National Watch Center

Hurricane Odalys (CAT-3) – Eastern Pacific

Situation: (Advisory #26, as of 5:00 a.m. ET)

- Located **925** miles WSW of the southern tip of Baja California
- Moving **N** at **5** mph
- Maximum sustained winds **115** mph
- Hurricane force winds extend **30** miles from center; tropical-storm-force winds extend **140** miles from center
- **Weakening** is forecast through early next week



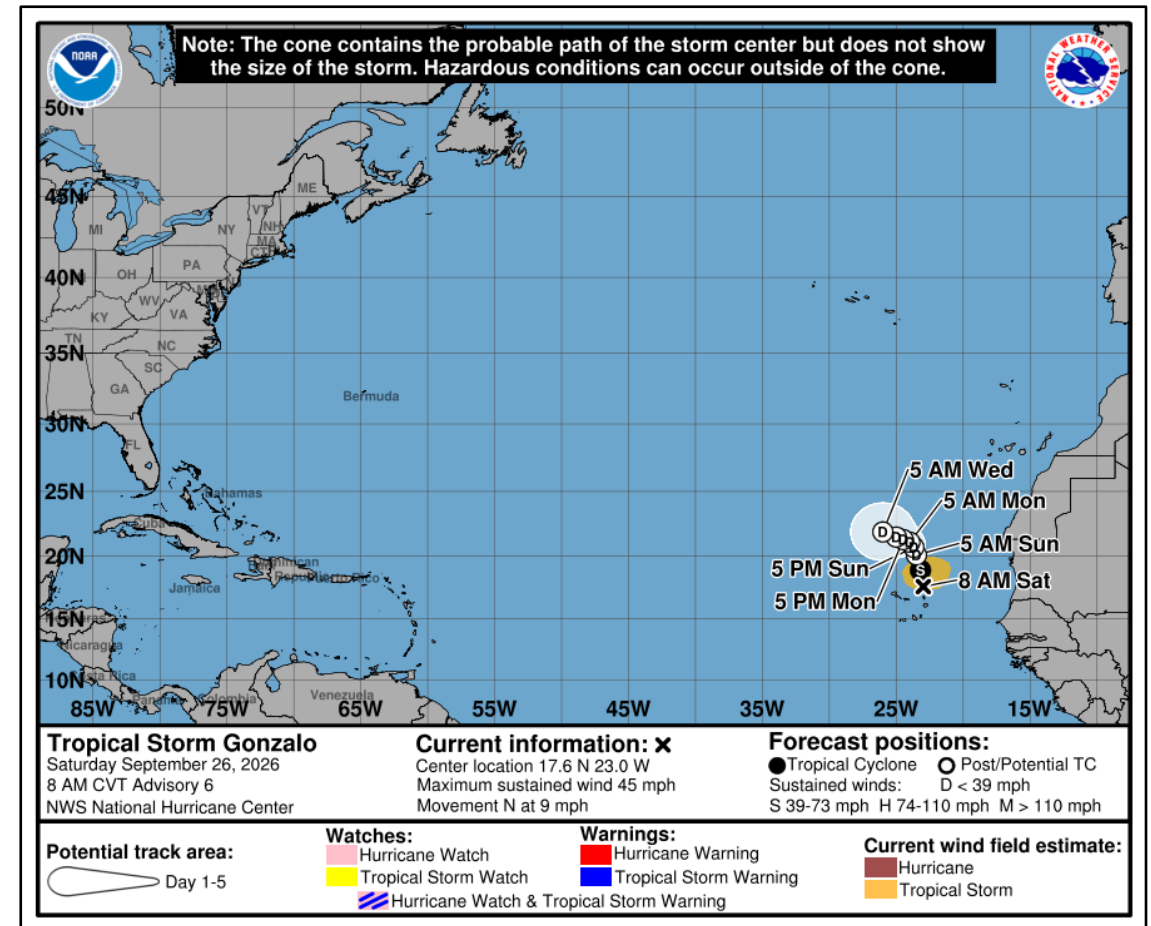
FEMA

National Watch Center

Tropical Storm Gonzalo – Atlantic

Situation: (Advisory #6, as of 5:00 a.m. ET)

- Located 60 miles N of the Cabo Verde Islands
- Moving N at 9 mph
- Maximum sustained winds 45 mph
- Tropical storm winds extend outward up to 185 miles
- Some strengthening is possible today, with a gradual weakening trend forecast to begin this weekend



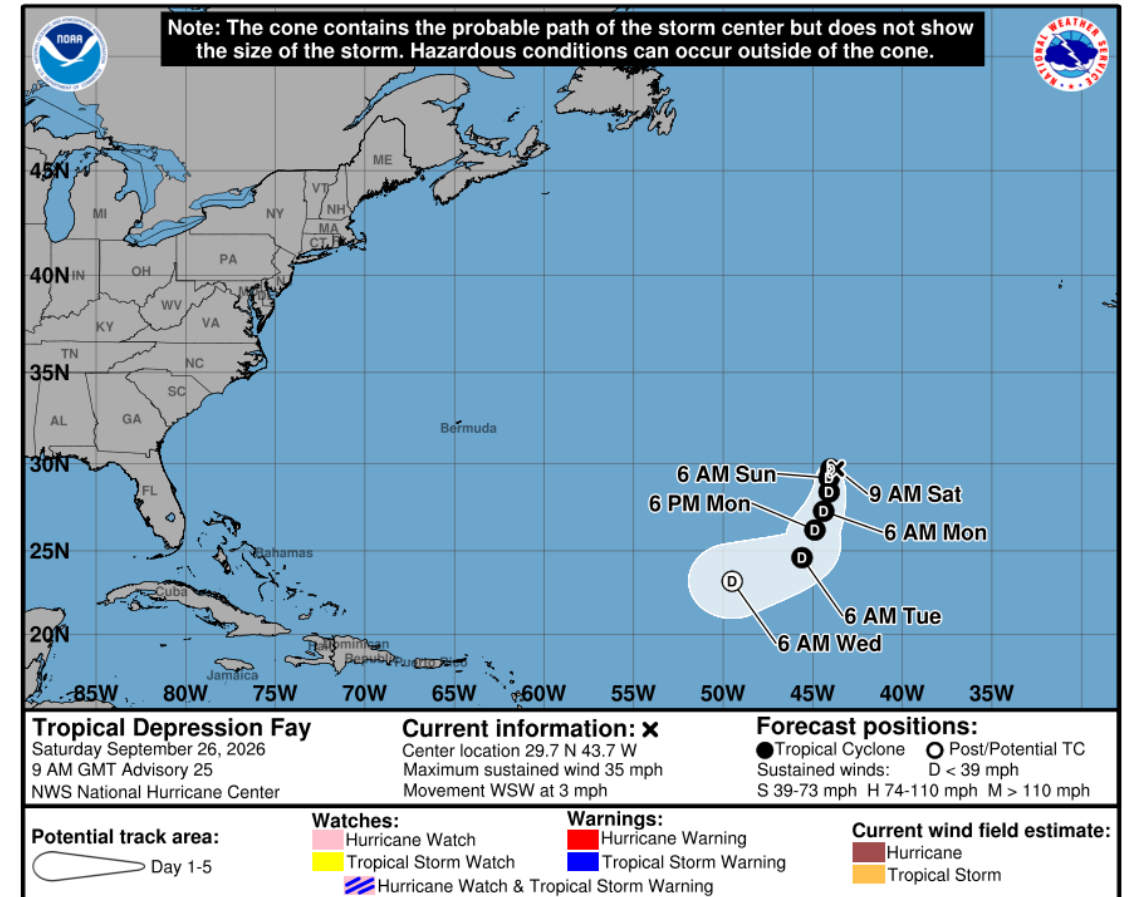
FEMA

National Watch Center

Tropical Depression Fay – Atlantic

Situation: (Advisory #25, as of 5:00 a.m. ET)

- Located **1,115** miles WSW of the Azores
- Moving **WSW** at **3** mph
- Maximum sustained winds **35** mph
- **Little change in strength** is forecast over the next several days



FEMA

National Watch Center

Nor'easter – Mid-Atlantic to Northeast



Situation: A rapidly strengthening Nor'easter will affect the Mid-Atlantic and Northeast from tonight through early next week. Major coastal flooding is expected along the Mid-Atlantic coast through the weekend, especially during high-tide cycles, with 1-2 feet of inundation possible near shorelines. Wind gusts of 45-65 mph are possible across eastern Long Island and southeastern New England, which may cause power outages and tree damage. Heavy rain may also lead to flooding inland from northern New Jersey through southern New England through Monday. (NOAA LNO, as of 2:31 p.m. ET, Sep 25)

Lifeline Impacts: (FEMA R2 SLB, as of 3:16 p.m. ET, Sep 25)

Safety & Security: State staging rescue vehicles

- NJ: State ESF-9 is staging high water vehicles and debris removal teams
- NY: Office of Prevention Control staging high axle vehicles and swift water rescue teams

State / Local Response:

FEMA Region 1:

- CT SEOC at Partial Activation (Nor'easter)
- RI SEOC will activate to Partial Activation at 10:00 a.m. ET, Sep 26 (Nor'easter)

FEMA Region 2:

- NJ SEOC is Monitoring (Nor'easter); Governor declared a State of Emergency on Sep 25
- NY SEOC is Monitoring (Severe Weather); Governor declared a State of Emergency on Sep 25

FEMA Region 3:

- VA SEOC is Monitoring (Drought)
- DE and MD SEOCs are Monitoring (Nor'easter)

FEMA / Federal Response:

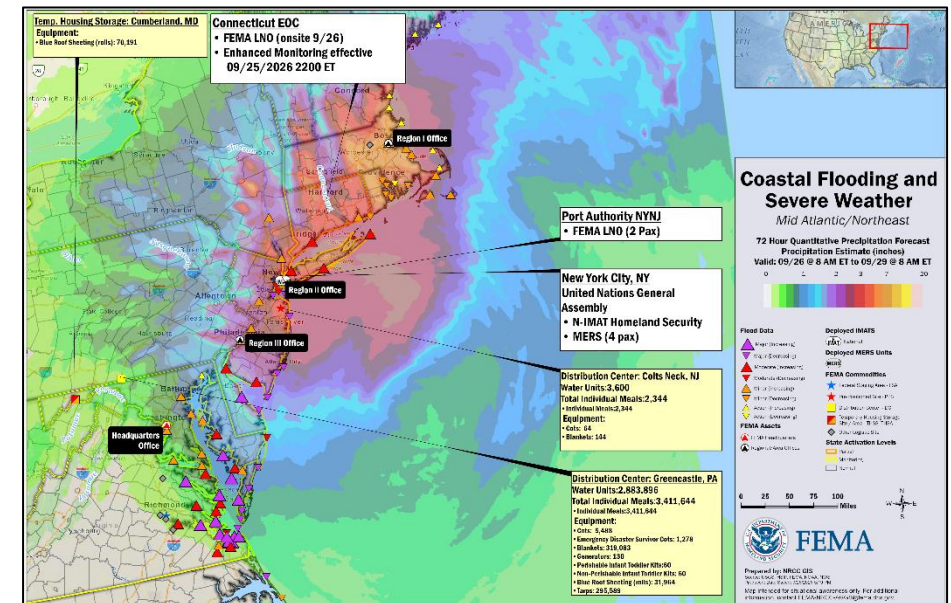
FEMA Region 1: RWC is Monitoring; RRCC is Activated (Nor'easter); R-IMAT is Available

- Monitoring power status and in coordination with ESF-3, PRTs are ready to deploy; generators are available

FEMA Region 2: RWC is Monitoring; RRCC is Activated (UN General Assembly/Coastal Storm; Virtual due to power outage not caused by weather); R-IMAT is Available

FEMA Region 3: RWC at Enhanced Monitoring (Nor'easter); RRCC is Activated; R-IMAT is Available

HQ: NWC is Monitoring, will be at Enhanced Watch (TC Nolo/Nor'easter) (12:00 p.m.-12:00 a.m. ET); N-IMAT White & Blue are available

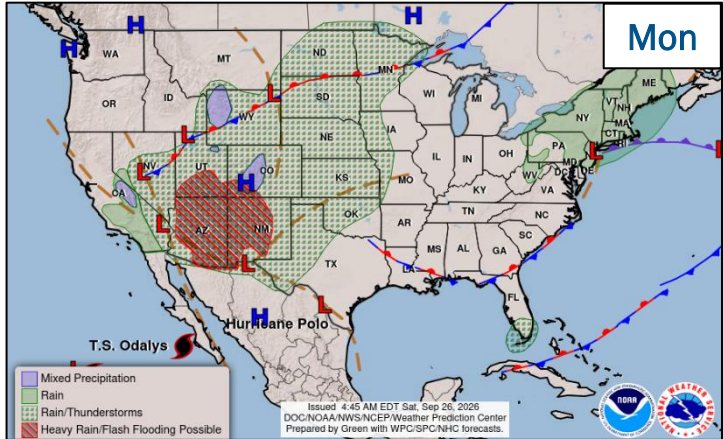
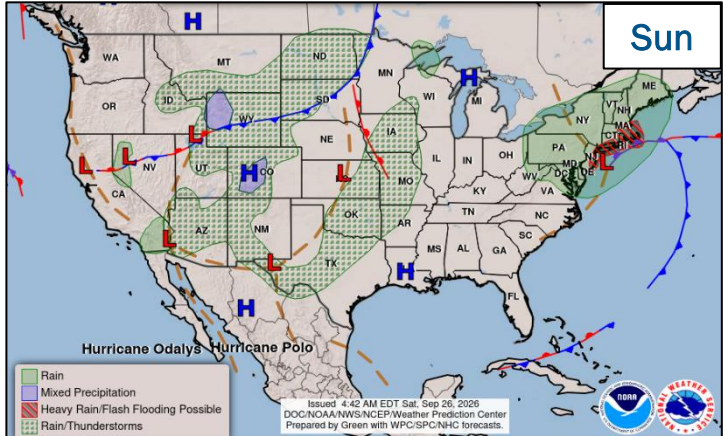
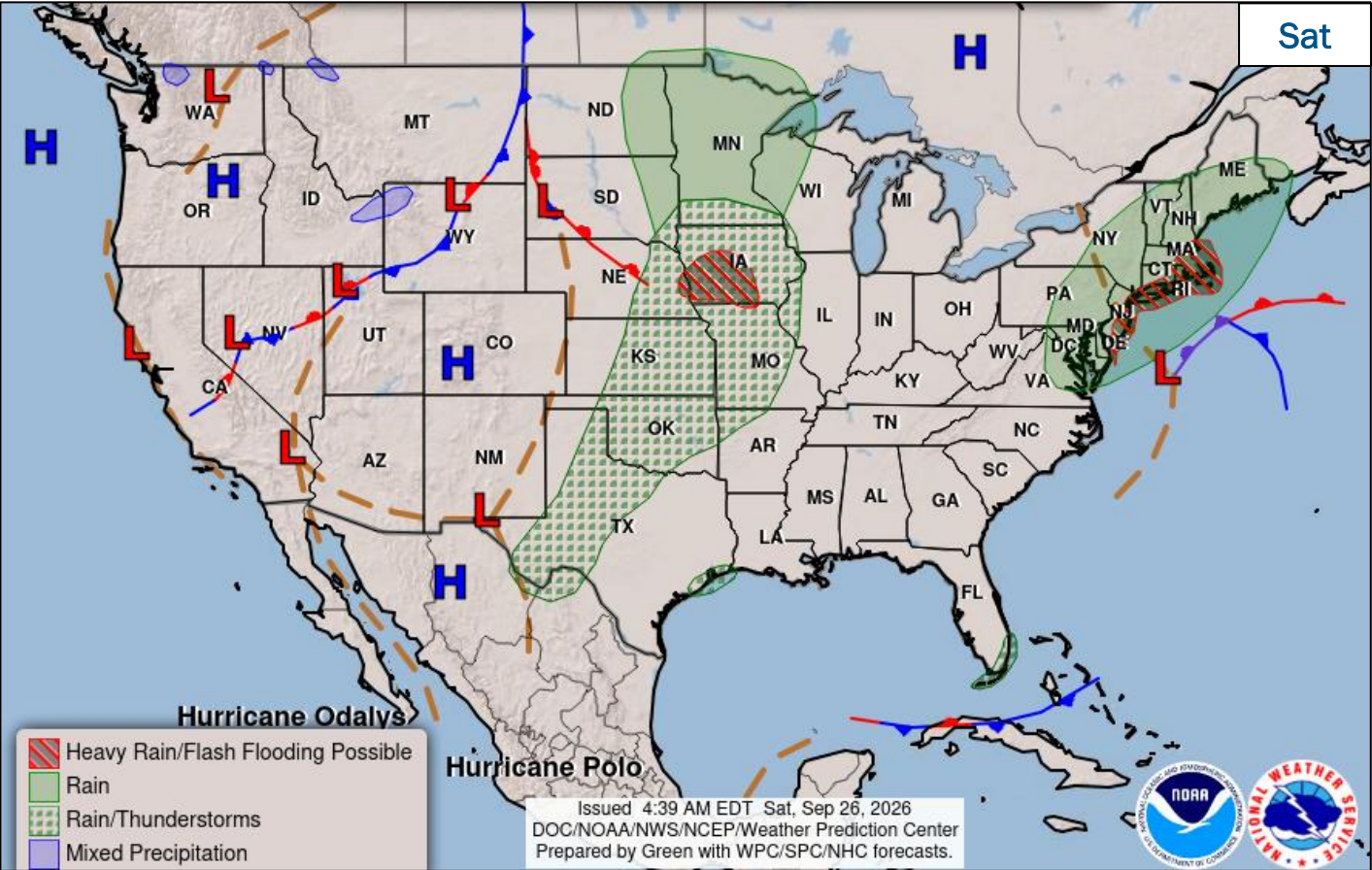


FEMA

NWC will continue to monitor in coordination with FEMA Regions 1, 2, and 3, with continued reporting twice daily in the FEMA National Situation Report (3:00 a.m. / 5:00 p.m. ET) and the FEMA Daily Operations Briefing (8:30 a.m. ET).

National Watch Center

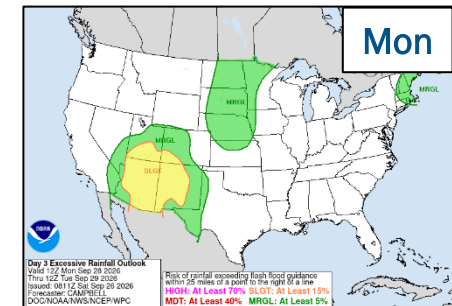
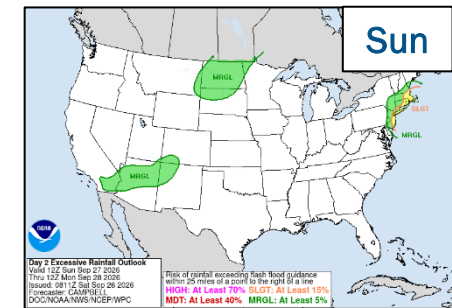
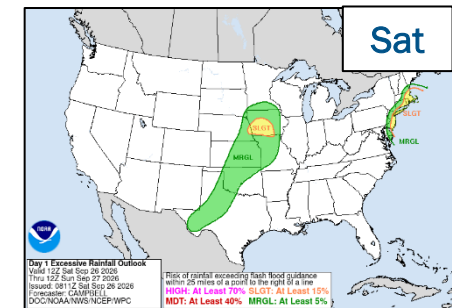
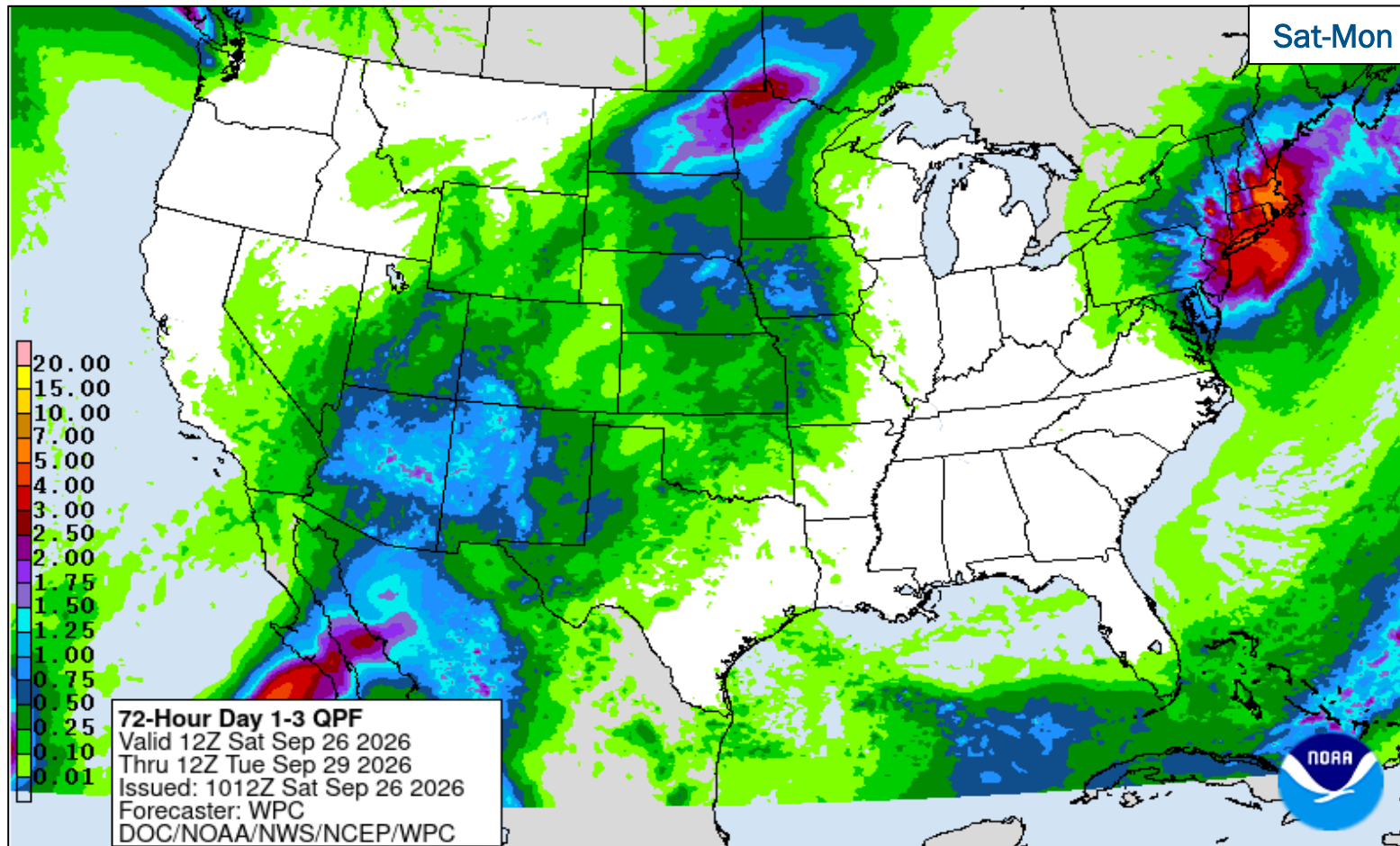
National Weather Forecast



FEMA

National Watch Center

Precipitation & Excessive Rainfall



FEMA

National Watch Center

INITIAL ATTACK ACTIVITY (24-hour period)	Light (70 fires)
New Large Fires	1
Large Fires Contained	2
Uncontained Large Fires	26
Year-to-Date Acres Burned	8,559,351
Total Responders	7,344
Type 1 IMTs Deployed	0
Complex IMTs Deployed	6
FMAGS	Total
2026 (FYTD)	63
2025	75
3 Year Average	53

Preparedness Levels:	
PL 1	Minimal fire activity; many resources available
PL 2	Large wildland fires burning throughout country; resources mobilized from other areas
PL 3	Wildfire activity ongoing throughout 25% of country; National Interagency Coordination Center (NICC) sets priorities, allocates resources, and mobilizes assets at national level
PL 4	High levels of fire activity and areas are competing for firefighting resources; 60% of the nation's wildland firefighting resources committed
PL 5	Extremely high levels of fire activity; 80% of nation's firefighting resources committed





FEMA Common Operating Picture

National Watch Center

Incident Workforce

18,832
Assigned a Disaster Title

5,983 / 32%
Deployed

6,413 / 34%
Available to Deploy for 30 Days

6,436 / 34%
Remaining

Surge Capacity Force
7,697 / 0 / 769
Rostered / Deployed /
Est. Available to Deploy for 30 Days

Saturday
September 26, 2026
8:30 a.m. ET

National Readiness

National Watch Center

NRCC

N-IMAT Red

N-IMAT White

N-IMAT Blue

N-IMAT Gold

N-IMAT HS

National Notes

National Watch Center:

- Staffing: will be at Enhanced Watch (TC Nolo/Nor'easter) (12:00 p.m.-12:00 a.m. ET)

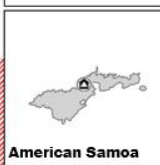
NRCC:

- Rostered

National IMATs:

- N-IMAT Red: TC Nolo
- N-IMAT White: Staffing
- N-IMAT Blue: Staffing
- N-IMAT HS: UNGA

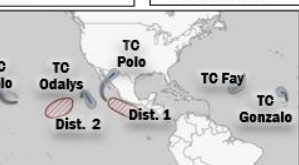
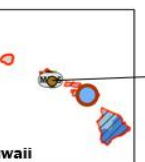
REGIONAL BREAKDOWN					
	JFO	DR	EM	JRO	
R1	0	1	0	0	
R2	0	0	0	2	
R3	0	2	0	0	
R4	3	10	0	1	
R5	0	3	0	0	
R6	4	7	3	3	
R7	0	9	0	0	
R8	0	9	0	0	
R9	0	6	7	0	
R10	4	7	2	0	



Tracy, CA
TC Nolo
• SMT Tracy

CNMI
DR-4910-MP &
EM-3647-MP
• R9 IMAT-2

Guam
DR-4921-GU &
EM-3648-GU
• ISB Delta



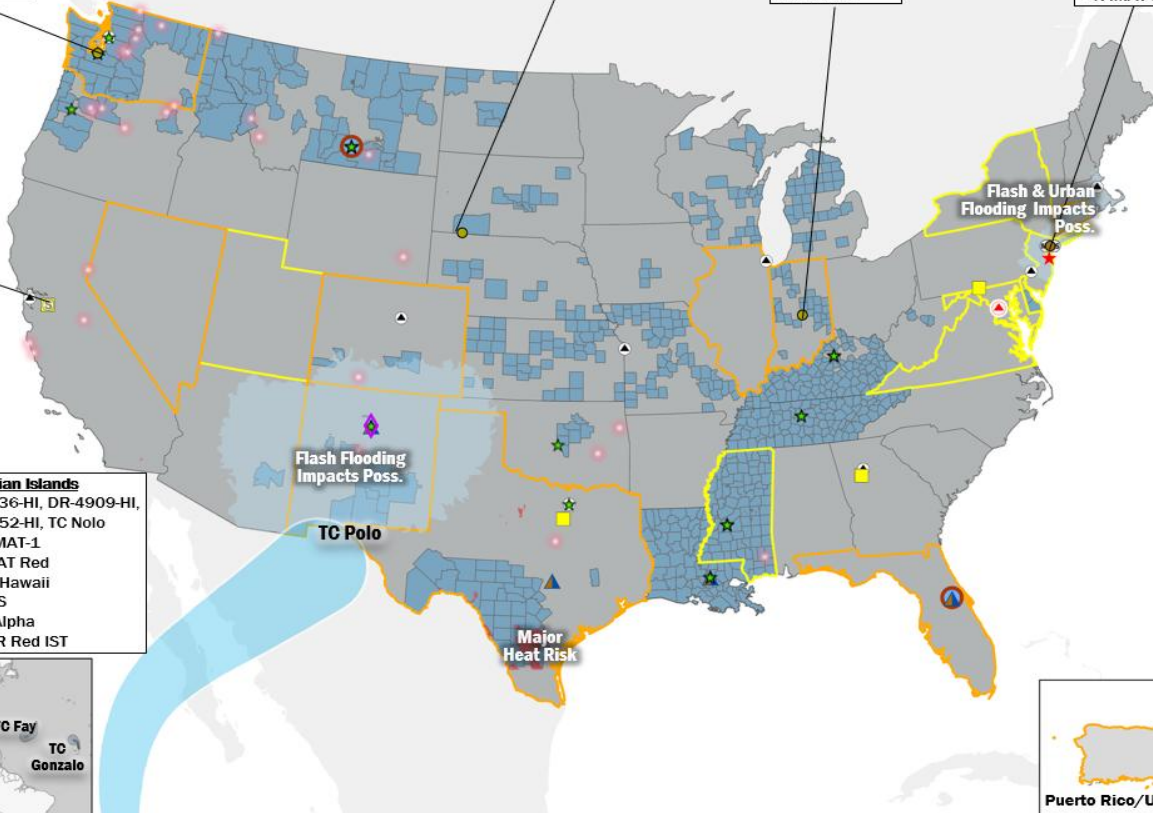
Hawaiian Islands
DR-4936-HI, DR-4909-HI,
EM-3652-HI, TC Nolo
• R9 IMAT-1
• N-IMAT Red
• SMT Hawaii
• MERS
• ISB Alpha
• US&R Red IST

Camp Murray, WA
EM-3650-WA
• R10 IMAT

Pine Ridge, SD
DR-4941-OST
• R8 IMAT

Indianapolis, IN
DR-4933-IN
EM-3651-IN
• R5 IMAT

New York, NY
UNGA
• MERS
• N-IMAT HS



- FEMA Headquarters
- Regional Offices
- National IMAT
- Regional IMAT
- MERS
- Incident Support Base
- Staging Management Team
- Pre-Positioned Site
- Distribution Center
- Open Joint Field Offices
- Recovery Support Function Activations
- Joint Recovery Office
- Direct Housing Missions
- Large Fires
- State Activation Levels
- Full
- Partial
- Monitoring
- Normal
- Declared Counties

Regional Readiness

Watch RRCC IMAT

Region 1

Region 2

Region 3

Region 4

Region 5

Region 6

Region 7

Region 8

Region 9

Region 10

Regional Notes

Watches/RRCCs:

- R2 Watch: Equipment
- R3 Watch: Nor'easter
- R5 Watch: Staffing
- R9 Watch: TC Nolo
- R1 RRCC: Nor'easter (Virtual)
- R2 RRCC: UNGA/Nor'easter
- R3 RRCC: Nor'easter
- R9 RRCC: TC Nolo
- R10 RRCC: Staffing
- State EOCs:
- FL/MS: Previous Incidents
- CO/NV/TX/UT/WA: Wildfires
- IL/NJ/NY: Severe Weather
- NM: Excessive Rainfall
- MP: TC Bavi/Saudel
- PR/VA: Drought
- IN: 4933-DR-IN/3651-EM-IN
- HI: TC Lowell/Tropical Activity
- AK: West Coast Storms
- DE/MD: Nor'easter

IMATs:

- R1/R3/R4-1/2/R7: Staffing
- R5: 3651-EM-IN
- R8: 4941-DR-OST
- R9-1: 3652-EM-HI/4909-DR-HI/4936-DR-HI
- R9-2: 4910-DR-MP
- R10: 3650-EM-WA

Legend

- Fully Mission Capable
- Partially Mission Capable
- Requires Augmentation
- Deployed/Activated

Commodities & Equipment

	CONUS	Caribbean	Hawaii	Guam
Water				
Meals				
Generators				

SMT

Operational	11/11
Requires Augmentation	3/11
Deployed	2/11

MERS Det.

30/36 Operational	
Maynard	4/6
Frederick	6/6
Thomasville	6/6
Denton	6/6
Denver	4/6
Bothell	4/6

US&R

Task Forces	
Assigned	28
Non-FEMA Deployed	0
FEMA-Deployed	2
Not Mission Capable	0
Available	26
FEMA Support Staff	11/21

FCO

Assigned	38
Not Mission Capable	2
Deployed	33 (29 FCO)
Available	3

Joint Preliminary Damage Assessments

Region	State / Location	Event	IA	Number of Counties		Start – End
			PA	Requested	Complete	
R5	MN	Severe Weather Sep 19-20	IA	4	0	10/1 – TBD
			PA	0	0	N/A
R10	AK	Mukluk Fire Aug 21-25	IA	1	0	9/21 – TBD
			PA	1	0	9/21 – TBD



FEMA

Declaration Approval – Hawai'i

Declaration: Emergency Declaration – FEMA-3654-EM-HI

Date Requested: Sep 23

Date Approved: Sep 25

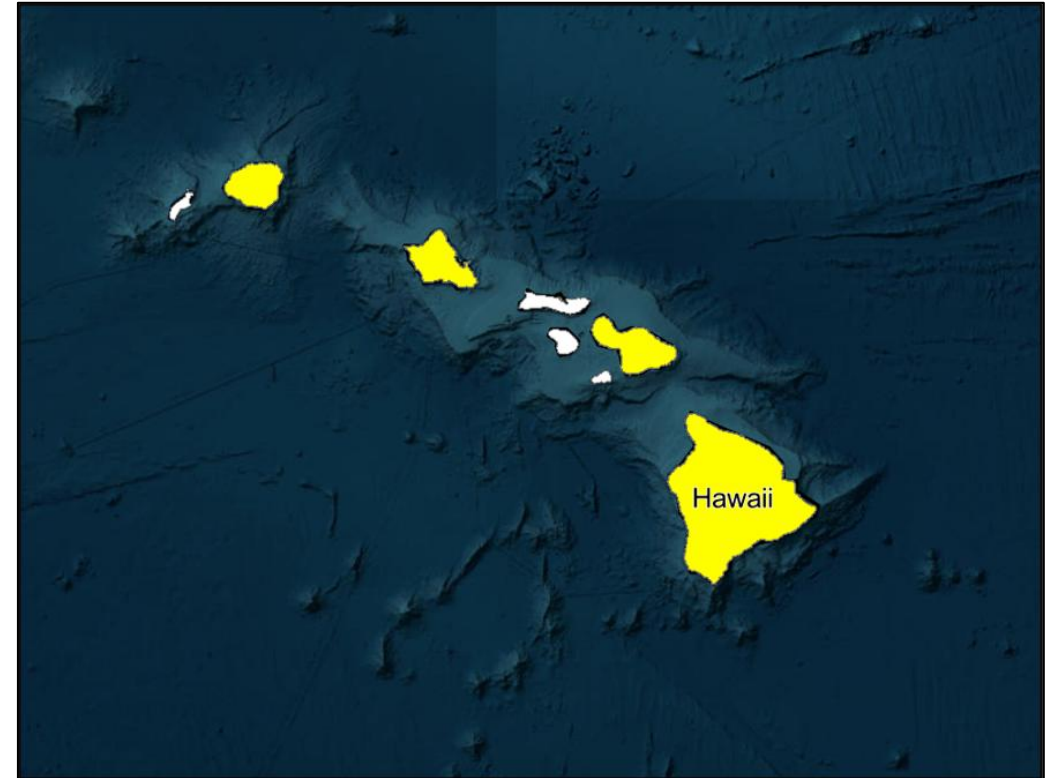
Incident: Tropical Storm Nolo

Incident Period: Sep 23, and continuing

Provides:

- **PA Only:** 4 counties, including the City and County of Honolulu
- **Hazard Mitigation:** Statewide

FCO: Hirokazu Toiya



PA



FEMA

Declaration Requests in Process – 16

State / Tribe / Territory – Incident Description	Type	IA	PA	HM	Requested
NH – Severe Storm and Flash Flooding – Appeal	DR		X	X	Jul 8
IN – Severe Storms, Straight-line Winds, Tornadoes, and Flooding	DR	X	X	X	Aug 6
GU – Super Typhoon Bavi	DR	X	X	X	Aug 11
MN – Severe Storms and Flooding	DR	X		X	Aug 20
UT – Cottonwood Fire, Flooding, and Mudslides	DR		X	X	Aug 22
WI – Severe Storms and Tornado	DR	X	X	X	Aug 26
WV – Severe Storm, Flooding, Landslides, and Mudslides – Appeal	DR	X		X	Aug 31
NE – Severe Storm, Straight-line Winds, and Flooding – Appeal	DR		X	X	Aug 31
OH – Severe Storms, Straight-line Winds, Tornadoes, Flooding, and Landslides	DR	X		X	Sep 2
OK – Severe Storms and Straight-line Winds	DR		X	X	Sep 2
TN – Severe Storm and Straight-line Winds	DR	X	X	X	Sep 8
HI – Hurricane Lala	DR	X	X	X	Sep 8
HI – Hurricane Lowell	DR	X	X	X	Sep 9
WV – Severe Storms and Flooding	DR	X		X	Sep 12
IL – Severe Storms, Straight-line Winds, Tornadoes, and Flooding	DR	X	X	X	Sep 15
KS – Severe Storm and Straight-line Winds	DR		X	X	Sep 15
HI – Hurricane Nolo – APPROVED	EM		X		Sep 23



FEMA

National Watch Center

Declaration Amendments

Declaration	Number	Issued	Action
FEMA-4935-DR-TX	2	Sep 24	Adds 4 counties for Public Assistance



FEMA

Helping people before, during, and after disasters.



Scan to subscribe to this briefing.